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Unit 1 - What is a Sensor?

PDF Documents

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UNIT 1 WHAT IS A SENSOR?



Have you ever seen automatic doors that open when you walk near them or lights that turn on themselves when you enter a room? These work because of a sensor!

A sensor is a special device that can sense or "feel" what is happening around it. It can detect light, heat, movement, or even sound. Once a sensor detects something, it sends a signal to a machine, telling it to take action. For example, a sensor on an automatic door detects when a person is nearby and signals the door to open.

Types of Sensors:



- 1 MOTION SENSORS** These detect movement. For example, a motion sensor might turn on a light when you walk in front of a motion sensor.
- 2 LIGHT SENSORS** These detect how much light is in an area. Streetlights often use light sensors to turn on when it gets dark outside.
- 3 TEMPERATURE SENSORS** These can sense how hot or cold it is. Your home thermostat uses a temperature sensor to control your heating or cooling system.

HOW DO SENSORS WORK?

Let's break it down in a simple way:

- 1 DETECTING SOMETHING** The sensor watches for changes in its surroundings (like movement, light, or temperature).
- 2 SENDING A SIGNAL** Once it detects something, it sends a message (signal) to a machine or device.
- 3 TAKING ACTION** The machine takes action based on the signal. For example, it could turn on a light, open a door, or start cooling a room.



Activity: Be the Sensor! _____

Find the sensors which is in your body! Write the name of the sensor and what it can do.

Sensor	What does it do?
<i>Vision</i>	<i>Get visual information..</i>